

WINDOWS DFIR INVESTIGATION REPORT

CASE HD-DFIR-001

Suspicious After-Hours Workstation Activity

Case type	Windows workstation investigation
Environment	Simulated incident / portfolio case
Primary tool	Autopsy
Supporting tool	Registry Explorer
Subject account	aarav.shah
Report status	Final

Prepared as a practical DFIR case study. Findings below are based on the supplied forensic artifacts and investigator observations.

1. Case Brief

Unusual after-hours activity was identified on a Windows workstation assigned to an employee account. A forensic artifact collection was examined to determine who used the workstation, what actions occurred during the session, whether confidential data was transferred, whether removable media was involved, and whether traces of the activity were removed.

Investigation objectives

- Identify the account associated with the after-hours session.
- Establish the relevant activity window.
- Determine whether removable storage was connected.
- Identify suspicious tools or commands used during the session.
- Determine whether Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx was transferred.
- Identify cleanup or anti-forensic activity.
- Reconstruct an evidence-supported timeline.

Evidence reviewed

Windows forensic artifacts supplied in the case evidence set, including account/session activity, removable-device records, PowerShell command history, browser activity, filesystem/deleted-file artifacts and related metadata. Analysis was performed primarily in Autopsy, with Registry Explorer available for registry verification.

2. Executive Summary

The examination identified an after-hours session associated with aarav.shah. During that session, a SanDisk Ultra Fit removable-storage device was connected. PowerShell evidence showed Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx being copied from the user's Documents directory to the E: volume. The file was also subjected to a hash calculation. Activity involving rclone.exe occurred during the same period, and the executable was later observed as deleted. PowerShell history contained Get-History and Clear-History activity. The removable device was removed shortly before the account logged off.

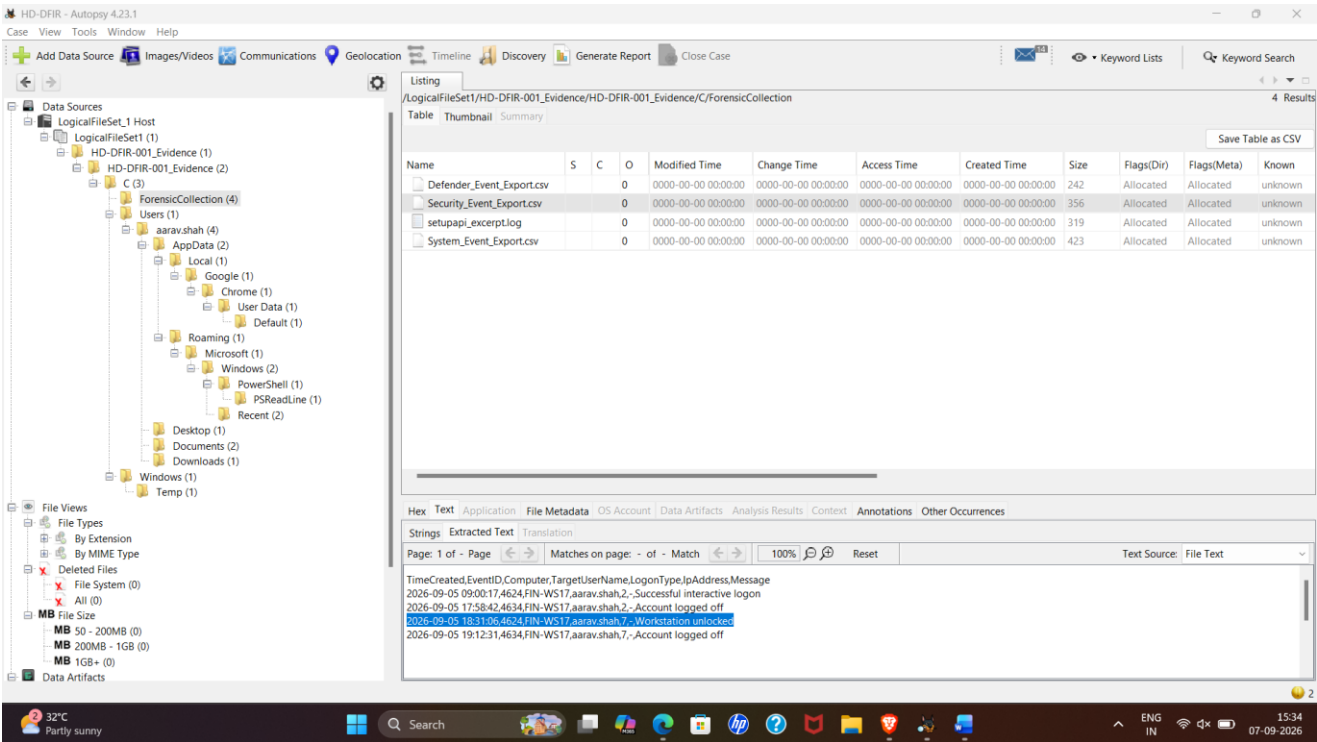
Overall assessment: The artifacts support deliberate access to the financial forecast file, transfer to the E: volume during the connected removable-device window, and subsequent cleanup activity.

3. Key Findings

Finding 01 - After-hours account activity

The account aarav.shah was associated with the workstation during the reported after-hours period. The session began at approximately 18:31:06 and ended at approximately 19:12:31.

Assessment: The subject account was active throughout the period in which the USB, file-copy and cleanup artifacts were recorded.



Evidence exhibit 01: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

Finding 02 - Removable storage connected

A SanDisk Ultra Fit device (Disk&Ven_SanDisk&Prod_Ultra_Fit\4C530001230905118431) was recorded as connected at 18:33:12 and removed at 19:10:08.

Assessment: The removable device was present for almost the entire suspicious activity window.

HD-DFIR - Autopsy 4.23.1

Case View Tools Window Help

Add Data Source Images/Videos Communications Geolocation Timeline Discovery Generate Report Close Case

Listing

/LogicalFileSet1/HD-DFIR-001_Evidence/HD-DFIR-001_Evidence/C/ForensicCollection

4 Results

Name	S	C	O	Modified Time	Change Time	Access Time	Created Time	Size	Flags(Dir)	Flags(Meta)	Known
Defender_Event_Export.csv			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	242	Allocated	Allocated	unknown
Security_Event_Export.csv			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	356	Allocated	Allocated	unknown
setupapi_excerpt.log			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	319	Allocated	Allocated	unknown
System_Event_Export.csv			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	423	Allocated	Allocated	unknown

Save Table as CSV

Hex Text Application File Metadata OS Account Data Artifacts Analysis Results Context Annotations Other Occurrences

Strings Extracted Text Translation

Page: 1 of - Page Matches on page: - of - Match 100% Reset Text Source: File Text

TimeCreated:EventData.ThreatName:Path:Action:
2026-09-05 18:36:02.1116 PUA-Win32/Presenoker.C/Users/aarav.shah/Downloads/yclone.exe.Detected
2026-09-05 18:36:10.1117 PUA-Win32/Presenoker.C/Users/aarav.shah/Downloads/yclone.exe.Allowed by user

-----METADATA-----

32°C Partly sunny

Search

ENG IN 15:38 07-09-2026

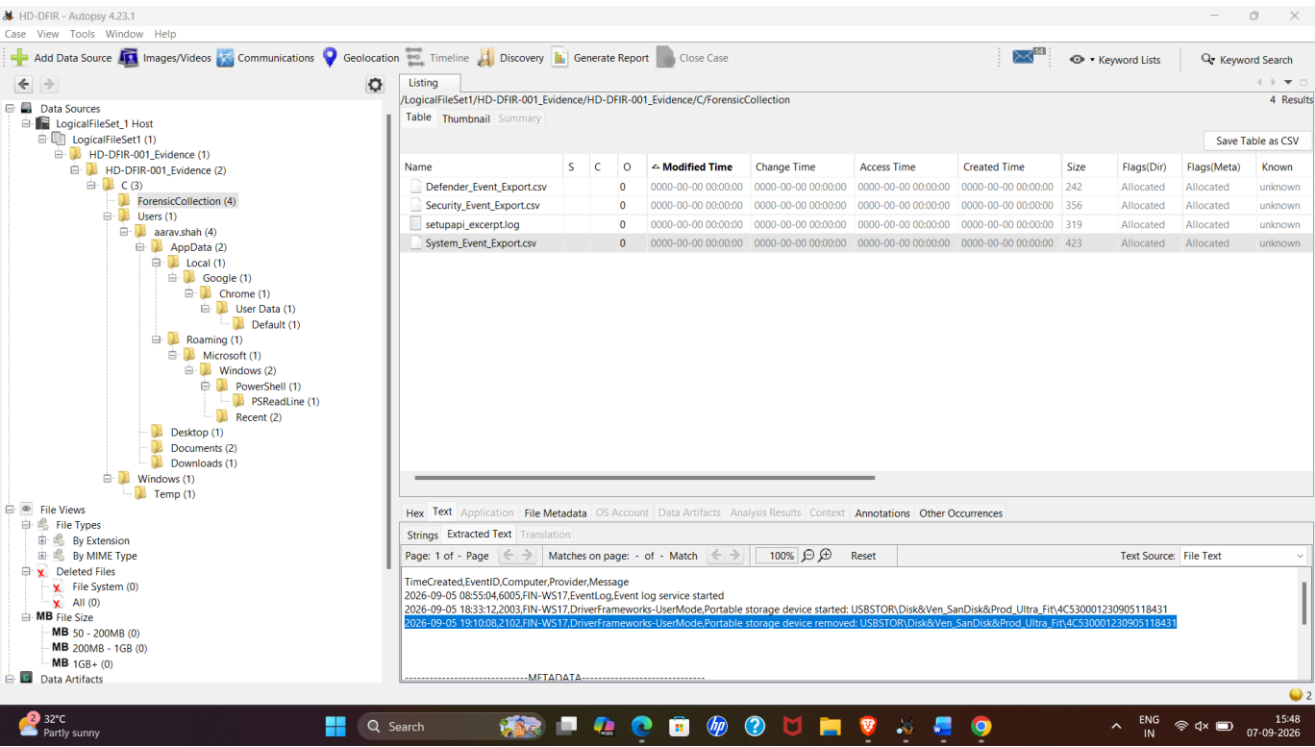
Evidence exhibit 02: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

Finding 03 - Financial forecast copied to E:

PowerShell history contained the command: Copy-Item

"C:\Users\aarav.shah\Documents\Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx" "E:\Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx".

Assessment: This is direct command evidence of a copy operation from the user's Documents directory to the E: volume. In the case timeline, the operation occurred while the SanDisk removable device was connected.

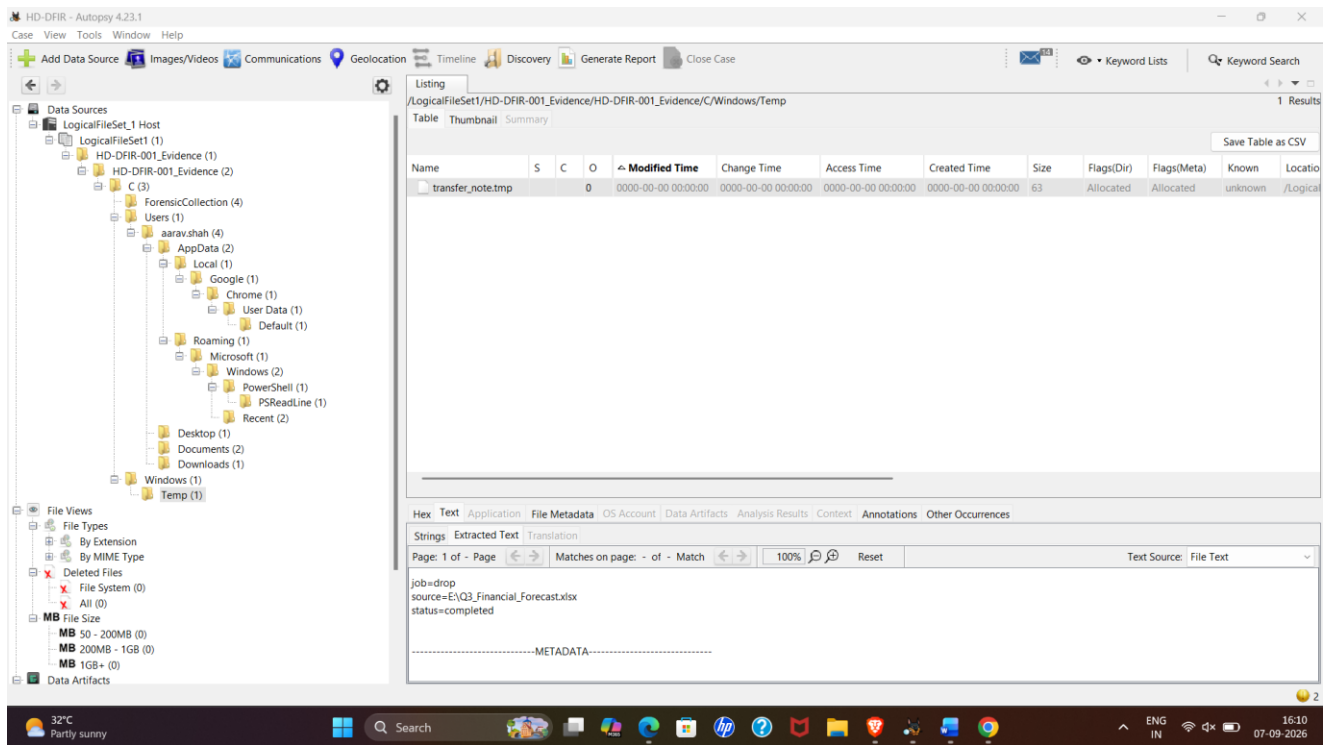


Evidence exhibit 03: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

Finding 04 - File hash calculated

PowerShell evidence showed a hash operation against the financial forecast file using Get-FileHash.

Assessment: The file was deliberately referenced and processed during the suspicious session, further tying it to the activity under investigation.

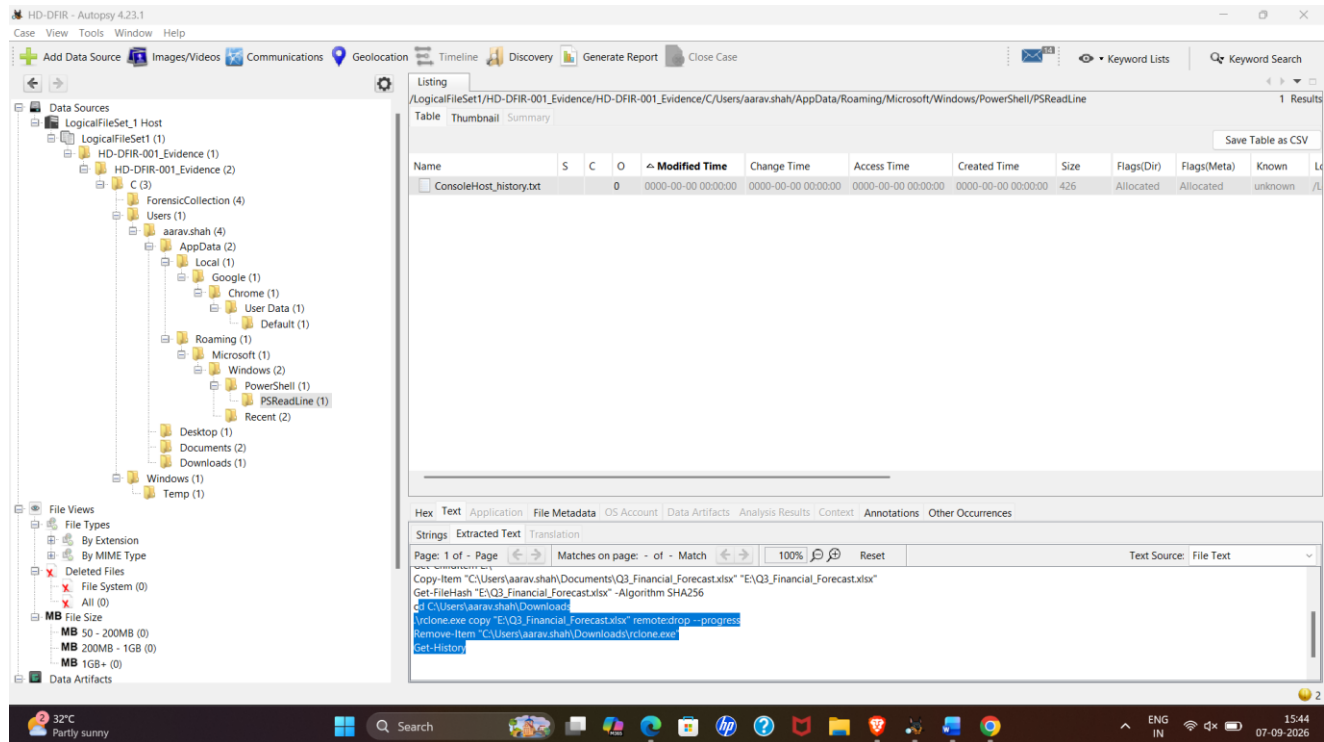


Evidence exhibit 04: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

Finding 05 - rclone activity and deletion

Artifacts showed activity involving rclone.exe at approximately 18:36:02, followed by user interaction/authorization around 18:36:10. Autopsy also showed rclone.exe as deleted later in the activity sequence.

Assessment: rclone was present and interacted with during the relevant session, and the later deleted-file evidence supports removal of the executable after use.

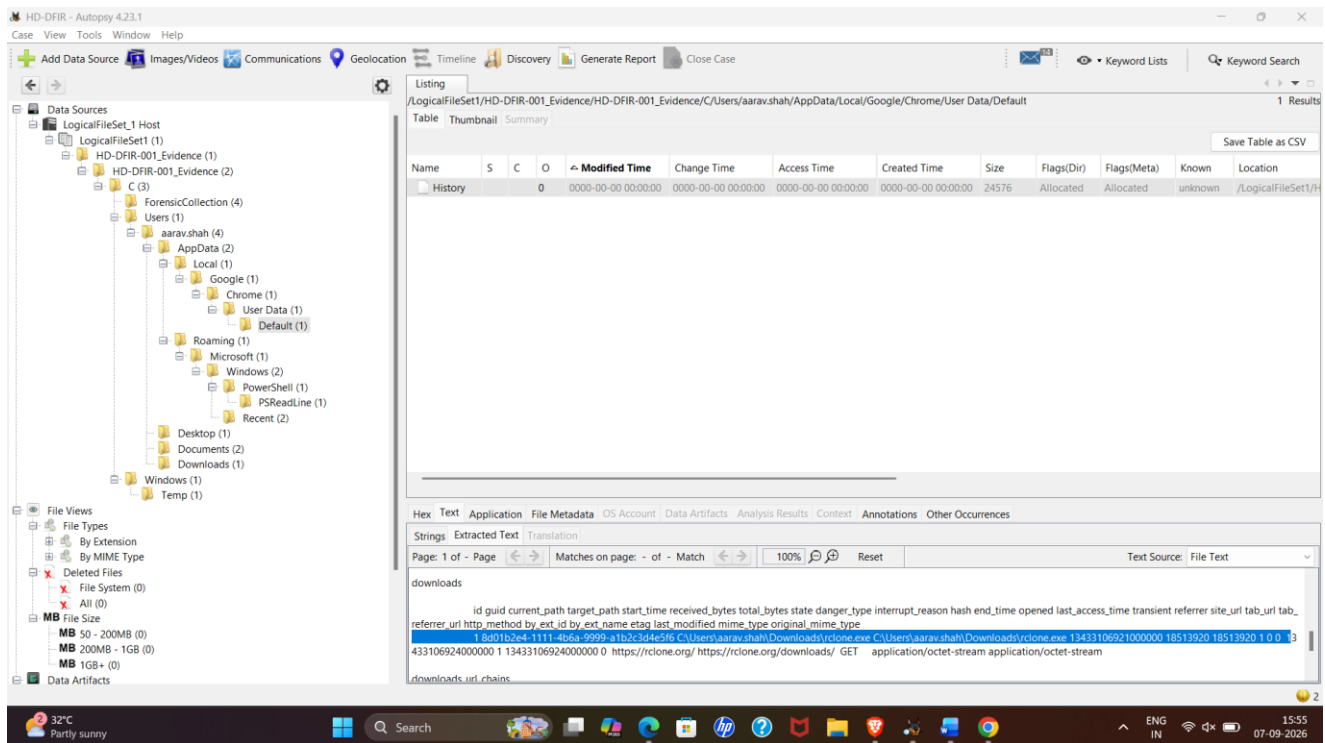


Evidence exhibit 05: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

Finding 06 - PowerShell history cleanup

PowerShell history included Get-History followed by Clear-History. Browser activity also included searches relating to file sharing and removal of PowerShell history.

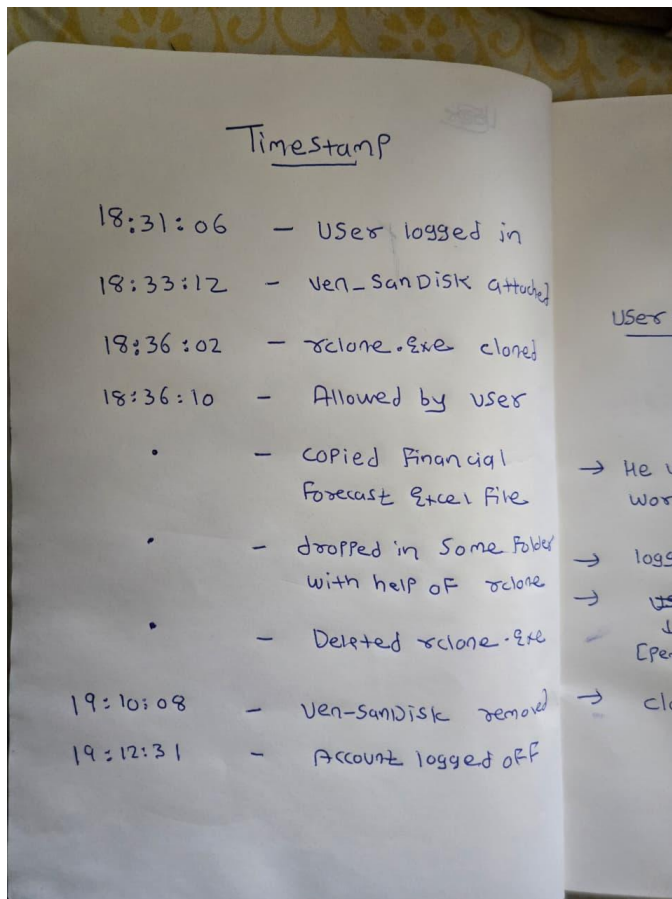
Assessment: Execution of Clear-History supports deliberate clearing of the current PowerShell session history. Browser searches provide additional context consistent with the observed command activity.



Evidence exhibit 06: Autopsy artifact view captured during analysis.

4. Reconstructed Timeline

Time	Observed activity	Assessment
18:31:06	aarav.shah session begins	Start of relevant after-hours activity.
18:33:12	SanDisk Ultra Fit connected	Removable storage becomes available.
18:36:02	rcclone.exe activity observed	Suspicious utility appears during session.
18:36:10	User interaction / authorization involving rclone	Continued interaction with executable.
During session	Get-FileHash against Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx	Financial file deliberately processed.
During session	Copy-Item ...Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx -> E:\Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx	Direct evidence of file-copy command to E:.
Later in session	Get-History / Clear-History	PowerShell session history queried and cleared.
Later in session	rcclone.exe observed deleted	Executable removed after relevant activity.
19:10:08	SanDisk Ultra Fit removed	Removable device disconnected.
19:12:31	Account logs off	End of relevant session.



Investigator working timeline created during analysis.

5. Proven Findings vs. Assessment

Supported directly by the reviewed evidence

- aarav.shah was active on the workstation during the relevant after-hours period.
- The SanDisk Ultra Fit device was connected from 18:33:12 until 19:10:08.
- PowerShell contained a Copy-Item command copying Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx from the user profile to E:.
- A hash of the financial forecast file was calculated using PowerShell.
- rclone.exe activity was present during the session and the executable was later observed as deleted.
- Get-History and Clear-History were used during the session.
- The removable device was disconnected shortly before the account logged off.

Assessment requiring correlation

The combined sequence is consistent with a deliberate transfer of the financial forecast to removable storage followed by cleanup. The copy command establishes the operation to E:. Attribution of E: to the identified SanDisk is strongest when the drive-letter/volume mapping artifact is preserved alongside the USB connection evidence.

6. Conclusion

The investigation established a coherent after-hours activity sequence involving aarav.shah, a connected SanDisk removable device, direct PowerShell file-copy activity involving Q3_Financial_Forecast.xlsx, rclone-related activity, and subsequent cleanup actions. The timing of these artifacts is closely aligned: removable storage was connected shortly after the session began and removed shortly before logoff. The evidence supports the conclusion that the confidential financial forecast was intentionally handled and copied to the E: volume during the suspicious session.

Case disposition

Finding: Suspicious after-hours data-transfer activity substantiated by the examined artifacts.

Recommended preservation: Retain the forensic collection, PowerShell history, USB/volume artifacts, relevant filesystem metadata and the calculated file hash as supporting evidence.